



A leading smart infrastructure organization
achieved 100% traceability across procurement
and invoice management.

Background

A leading smart infrastructure organization managing large-scale procurement and vendor operations faced critical challenges in handling supplier onboarding, invoice validation, and payment processing. With more than 2500 suppliers across materials and services, their processes were heavily manual, email-driven, and lacked visibility for both internal users and vendors.

Frequent changes in requirements, lack of traceability, and scattered communication resulted in delays and compliance gaps, prompting the company to look for a modern, scalable procurement automation platform.



Challenges

- Supplier onboarding was slow due to multiple approval layers handled through emails.
- Frequent follow-ups were required because of missed communications and incomplete submissions.
- Invoice submission and validation were manual, leading to high dependency on individuals.
- There was no real-time visibility into invoice status, approvals, or payment progress.
- Tracking TAT and SLA adherence was difficult and required manual effort.
- Audit trails were hard to establish as information was buried in email chains.
- Data mismatches, duplicate entries, and document errors were common.
- MSME compliance and statutory timelines were difficult to monitor consistently.

Solution Highlights

- A unified procurement and vendor invoice management platform was implemented to digitize the end-to-end procure-to-pay process.
- Vendor onboarding was automated with structured data capture and rule-based validations.
- PAN, GST, MSME, and bank account details were verified using API integrations.
- Separate approval workflows were configured for goods and services to reflect GRN-based and SES-based processes.
- OCR was enabled to automatically extract invoice data and reduce manual entry.
- The platform was tightly integrated with SAP for PO, GRN/SES, invoice posting, and payment status.
- Legacy vendor data was migrated through structured mapping, cleansing, and validation.
- Phased deployment and focused user training ensured smooth adoption across teams.





Impact Created

- Vendor onboarding timelines have been reduced significantly due to automation and validations.
- Invoice processing became faster and more predictable with improved TAT adherence.
- Procurement, finance, SCM, and business teams gained real-time visibility into workflows.
- Manual effort and data errors have been reduced substantially through OCR and auto-matching.
- Audit readiness improved with complete digital trails and system-based tracking.
- Vendors experienced faster responses, fewer follow-ups, and greater transparency.
- Cross-functional collaboration improved with standardized and controlled workflows.

Key Insights

- Email-based procurement processes do not scale with large and diverse vendor bases.
- Separate workflows for goods and services are critical for accuracy and efficiency.
- API-driven compliance checks significantly reduce risk and improve data reliability.
- OCR combined with ERP integration delivers maximum efficiency in invoice processing.
- Clean data migration is foundational to the success of any automation initiative.
- Transparency in status and TAT builds trust with vendors and improves internal adoption.



Conclusion

By replacing fragmented, manual processes with a fully automated procurement platform, the organization achieved greater efficiency, control, and transparency across its vendor lifecycle. The transformation not only resolved immediate operational challenges but also established a scalable, future-ready procurement ecosystem. With improved compliance, faster turnaround times, and stronger vendor relationships, the organization is now well-positioned to support sustained growth and operational excellence.



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